

case of ICICI). Some fund houses also allow online verification using PAN or Aadhaar number. The paperwork for KYC and SIP would take an hour or so. After that, the investing process is automated, translating to more time for daydreaming and vacation planning.

Why your career is the best hedge to your Investing Journey

A hedge is something investors use to lower risk on their portfolio. It can be done by buying bonds, shorting stocks or utilizing options. These are far corners of finance which a lay person need not enter. In fact, being employed, the best hedge we can have is our monthly salary.

As we looked at the importance of beating inflation, the other important issue is investing the right amounts. Having the right amount is only possible when we have a regular supply of cash. This is what a corporate career offers us - not just a monthly salary to keep us on the lifestyle treadmill, but also a chance to eliminate our dependence on such remuneration, by investing.

A corporate career or any salaried profession is not the rat race or a pointless pursuit it is often made out to be. Having a monthly salary is a boon that is often overlooked - we can save towards vacations with precision, invest for future big goals by allocating peanut money now and still have some portion left over to enjoy life. Besides, having this gravy coming in on a set date every month, we can automate every aspect of money - present, near future and distant future and not have a single worry in the world.

Gripe, but no gripe

Congratulations! A huge percentage of youngsters don't have a clue on what to do with money but as you start investing, you have slowly secured your future in parts. Now, there are more sophistications that can be included to your portfolio – investing separately toward a particular goal, getting aggressive with portfolio allocation depending on the goal etc. You can start dealing with them after a few years. For now, plough as much as possible in ICICI Pru Junior 50 Fund.

One criticism with investing in a Junior 50 index will be that during certain periods, other Mutual Funds will be achieving better returns. Some have